

PERSONAL CONNECTION: BUYING A CAR

This anecdote actually portrays me in a positive light. After years of regular wear and tear and being hit by rogue VW buses, it was time to get a new car. At this point in my life, I had already undergone the financial renaissance and was confident in my ability to negotiate a reasonable price for a quality car.

Before I went to any dealerships, I thoroughly researched the car I wanted and how much it should cost. I then began searching online to see the inventory of local dealerships. I ended up emailing six different dealerships about cars I was interested in, and started negotiating the price. With each email they would insist that I come in to speak with them in person, but I knew this was just to put more pressure on me and shift the bargaining advantage to their side. I eventually got down to two final competitors and decided to visit the dealerships.

I went to both dealerships and told them what the other person was offering. Eventually, I got to a point where neither side would budge any further and I chose the car that I felt had the best value. I also want to mention that although I was thrilled on the inside to see the salespeople competing for my business, I remained polite and courteous throughout the whole process. I think if I had acted smugly or disrespectfully, neither side would have been willing to work with me as much as they did.

In the end, I got a 2019 car for \$1,000 less than the price I expected to pay for a 2017. I was only able to get this deal because I was patient and thorough in each step of the process; I didn't let them rush me, and I didn't jump on the first offer. When it comes time for you to buy a car, I hope you can have the same experience and walk away satisfied with your purchase.